

## Serious Incident Report no. 12350/2021

|                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                      |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Report date and time (UTC)            | 2021-06-30                                                                                                                                                                                          | Sensitive Operational information x3 |
| Last modification date and time (UTC) | 2021-12-10                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                      |
| Reporting entity/function             | PALERMO                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                      |
| SIR Status                            | Closed                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                      |
| Workflow Status                       | Processed                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                      |
| SIR Category                          | 3 - Situations with serious actual or potential negative implications on Frontex core tasks<br>1 - Situations of potential violations of Fundamental Rights or international protection obligations |                                      |
| Subject                               | 7 people drowned and 9 people missing in shipwreck near Lampedusa                                                                                                                                   |                                      |
| Joint operation                       | JO Themis 2021                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                      |
|                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                      |
| Original source of information        | PALERMO                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                      |
| FX SI Handler                         | HoO.FRO                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                      |
| Frontex resources involved            | Yes                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                      |
| Use of force                          | No                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                      |
| Incident dates (UTC)                  | 2021-06-30                                                                                                                                                                                          | Sensitive Operational Information x8 |
| Location of the incident              | Lampedusa (Lampedusa e Linosa), Sicilia, Italy                                                                                                                                                      |                                      |
| Latitude                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                      |
| Longitude                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                      |
| Location details                      | Lampedusa                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                      |
| Reference to the operational area     | Yes                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                      |
| Type of resources / involvement       |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                      |
| Dead persons                          | 7                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                      |
| Injured persons                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                      |
| Missing persons                       | 9                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                      |

## Search and rescue

|                                |                  |
|--------------------------------|------------------|
| SAR activated date/time (UTC)  | 2021-06-30       |
| SAR activated by whom          |                  |
| Boat in distress type          | wood             |
| Flag, name, IMO if available   |                  |
| Detected by                    | XII MRSC PALERMO |
| Is Frontex co-financed asset?  | No               |
| Intercepted by                 | ITA/CG/CPV CP309 |
| Is Frontex co-financed asset?  | No               |
| Estimated people on board      | 63               |
| Planned port of disembarkation | LAMPEDUSA        |
| Departure country              | Unknown          |
| Involved authorities           | MRCC ROME        |

## Details

Reporting Tools

Sensitive Operational Information x5  
and

## Technical Equipment x4

Information/Allegations

On 30.06.2021 at [REDACTED] LT, ITA/CG [REDACTED] located a wooden boat in distress with migrants on board in position [REDACTED] from the island of Lampedusa. [REDACTED] and [REDACTED] were in the area and immediately proceeded to rescue the migrants recovering 46 persons and 4 bodies.

At [REDACTED] T [REDACTED] recovered another body.

At [REDACTED] LT, [REDACTED] recovered two more bodies.

According to the initial information, the wooden boat sailed from Tunisia (Sidi Mansur area). The boat sunk and cannot be retrieved.

All of the 7 corpses brought to the Favaro pier by the patrol boats of the Port Authority are of sub-Saharan women.

Sensitive Operational Information x22  
and

## Technical Equipment x13

Measures/Actions taken

A SAR operation was immediately launched. [REDACTED] Rome dispatched the [REDACTED] deployed in Lampedusa to be engaged in the SAR operation. Besides the [REDACTED], MRCC engaged [REDACTED] and all available [REDACTED] in the area [REDACTED].

Below is the timeline of the searches carried out:

- from [REDACTED] LT to [REDACTED] LT, [REDACTED], with negative results;
- from [REDACTED] LT to [REDACTED] LT, [REDACTED] and [REDACTED], [REDACTED] and [REDACTED], with negative result;
- from [REDACTED] LT to [REDACTED] LT, [REDACTED]), with negative result;
- from [REDACTED] LT to [REDACTED] LT, [REDACTED]), with negative result;
- from [REDACTED] LT to [REDACTED] LT, [REDACTED], with negative result;
- from [REDACTED] LT to [REDACTED] LT, [REDACTED], with negative result;
- from [REDACTED] LT to [REDACTED] LT, [REDACTED]), with negative result;
- from [REDACTED] LT to [REDACTED] LT, [REDACTED], with negative result.

Assessment

According to the statements provided by the rescued migrants, there were approximately 62-63 persons on board the boat. Therefore, in accordance with the statements collected, another 8/9 people are considered missing. Upon FRO's assessment the specific case may entail potential Fundamental Rights violations

Personal Data

## Final Report

Key points

Description of the event - Timeline

Information collected -  
Contributors/Entities consulted -  
Follow-up

Assessment

Final conclusion - Proposals - Lessons  
learned

Based on the available information it can be concluded that the death of seven persons and the disappearance of nine persons was a result of an accident. There is no link between the actions or failure to act of the authorities and the deaths and disappearances. The potential violation of the EU or international law related to fundamental rights and international protection obligations cannot be identified.

Taking into consideration all collected evidence received from the respective national authorities and Frontex internal entities, FRO suggests considering the present incident to be closed. Simultaneously, FRO recommends establishing national procedures of effective communication ensuring a proper distribution of simple instructions in key languages to people in distress at sea, which could be used in similar emergency cases in future.

Out of Scope

Reporting Tools